

Task 3: UX Case Study — Zomato Food Delivery App

Prepared by: Maryam Nauman

Internship: CodeAlpha — UI/UX Design

Tool Used: Figma (for improvement mockups)

Subject App: Zomato (Android/iOS)

Introduction & App Overview

About Zomato

Zomato is one of South Asia's most widely used food delivery and restaurant discovery platforms, operating across India, Pakistan, and several international markets. Launched in 2008, it serves millions of users daily through its mobile app and website, connecting customers to thousands of local restaurants for online ordering, table reservations, and food reviews. As of 2026, Zomato remains a dominant player in the food-tech industry with a strong brand presence and a highly competitive user experience.

Why Zomato?

Zomato was selected for this UX case study because it represents a complex, real-world product with multiple user flows — from browsing and searching to ordering, payment, and live tracking. This complexity makes it an ideal subject for identifying meaningful UX opportunities. Additionally, Zomato is a product most users interact with daily, which provides a rich opportunity to analyze real pain points from a user perspective.

Research Methodology

This case study is based on a heuristic evaluation of the Zomato mobile app combined with an analysis of publicly available user reviews on the Google Play Store and Apple App Store. The analysis followed Nielsen's 10 Usability Heuristics as a framework to evaluate the app's strengths and weaknesses systematically.

User Journey Analysis

Primary User Persona

Name: Areeba — a 22-year-old university student in Lahore **Goal:** Order food quickly during study hours without confusion **Frustration:** Too many steps to complete an order, unclear delivery time estimates, confusing discount codes

User Journey Map

Step 1 — Discovery/Entry: User opens the Zomato app after feeling hungry. They are greeted by a location-detection screen and then a homepage with a search bar, banner ads, category filters (Biryani, Pizza, Burgers), and a "What's on your mind?" scroll section.

Step 2 — Browse & Search: User either searches for a specific dish or browses by category. Filter options are available (rating, delivery time, price range, offers). Restaurant listings show estimated delivery time, rating, price range, and promotional tags.

Step 3 — Restaurant Selection: User opens a restaurant page showing the menu, photos, reviews, and an "Add to Cart" flow. Menu is organized by category (Starters, Mains, Deals etc.)

Step 4 — Cart & Checkout: User reviews their cart, applies coupon codes (if available), selects delivery address, and chooses a payment method (card, cash, digital wallet).

Step 5 — Order Tracking: After placing the order, a live tracking screen shows the order being confirmed, prepared, picked up, and delivered — with a map view and estimated time.

Step 6 — Post-Delivery: User is prompted to rate the restaurant and delivery experience with stars and written feedback.

Strengths & Weaknesses

Strengths

1. Rich Visual Content: Zomato uses high-quality food photography throughout the app. Restaurant cards and menu items feature appealing images that significantly increase user appetite and confidence in ordering. This visual-first approach is one of Zomato's strongest UX decisions.

2. Live Order Tracking: The real-time tracking feature, showing the rider's location on a live map, is highly effective at reducing user anxiety during the wait. This transparency builds trust and keeps the user informed at every step of the delivery.

3. Powerful Filter & Search System: Zomato's search allows filtering by cuisine type, rating, delivery time, dietary preference (veg/non-veg), and offers. This level of filtering

helps users narrow down choices quickly, especially in cities with hundreds of restaurant options.

4. Social Proof Integration: User reviews, photo uploads by customers, and aggregate ratings are prominently displayed on every restaurant page. This peer-driven validation strongly influences decision-making and adds authenticity to the platform.

5. Seamless Reorder Flow: Zomato remembers past orders and surfaces a "Reorder" shortcut prominently, which reduces friction significantly for repeat customers — a strong retention-focused UX feature.

Weaknesses

1. Overwhelming Homepage: The homepage is visually cluttered with too many competing elements — promotional banners, category carousels, "trending" sections, sponsored listings, and notifications all compete for attention simultaneously. This violates the UX principle of visual hierarchy and can overwhelm first-time users or users in a hurry.

2. Confusing Discount & Coupon System: Discount codes and offers are scattered across different sections of the app — some on the homepage banner, some visible only inside the cart, and some only after selecting a restaurant. Users frequently report applying a coupon only to discover it is ineligible at checkout, causing frustration at the most critical moment of the journey.

3. Inaccurate Delivery Time Estimates: A frequently reported pain point in user reviews is the gap between the estimated delivery time shown before ordering and the actual delivery time. This inconsistency damages user trust and creates negative experiences, especially for time-sensitive orders.

4. Difficult Address Management: Adding or editing a delivery address mid-order involves several steps and is not intuitive, particularly when a user wants to deliver to a new location or correct a previously saved address. The flow requires users to exit the cart, which risks losing their order progress.

5. No Order Customization Memory: If a user frequently orders the same item with specific customizations (e.g., extra spicy, no onions), Zomato does not remember these preferences, requiring the user to reselect them every single time — a missed opportunity for personalization.

Suggested Improvements

Improvement 1 — Simplified Homepage with Personalized Feed

Problem: The current homepage overwhelms users with too many sections and ads competing for attention.

Solution: Redesign the homepage into two clear zones — a top "Quick Actions" bar (Search, Reorder, Offers) and below it a personalized feed showing only restaurants and cuisines relevant to the user's past behavior. Reduce banner ads to a single rotating card instead of multiple stacked promotions. Add a clean "Mood Filter" row: Hungry in a hurry · Exploring new food · Deals only — which sets the feed context instantly.

Mockup Description: A cleaner hero with a single bold search bar, one personalized greeting ("Good evening, Areeba — order again from Howdy?"), a single small banner, and a curated 3-section feed: Recent Orders · Near You · Top Rated. Visual noise is reduced by 60% compared to the current design.

Impact: Reduces decision fatigue, makes the app feel personal, and speeds up the path to ordering — directly improving conversion rate.

Improvement 2 — Transparent & Unified Offers System

Problem: Discount codes are confusing, scattered, and often fail at checkout — the worst possible moment to disappoint a user.

Solution: Create a dedicated "My Offers" tab visible at all times in the bottom navigation. Each offer card clearly shows: which restaurants it applies to, the exact discount amount, minimum order requirement, and expiry date. During checkout, only eligible offers for the current cart are shown automatically — no manual code entry required. Invalid codes are never shown at the wrong stage.

Mockup Description: A bottom nav tab with a small "%" badge showing available offers count. Inside, offer cards are color-coded: Green = active and applicable to current cart, Gray = not applicable right now, Red = expiring today. At checkout, a single "Best Offer Applied" line appears automatically with the savings shown in green.

Impact: Eliminates the single most-reported frustration in Zomato user reviews, directly improving checkout completion rates and user trust.

Improvement 3 — Smart Delivery Time with Honest Estimation

Problem: Delivery time estimates shown before ordering frequently do not match reality, breaking user trust.

Solution: Replace the single static estimate ("30 mins") with a transparent range-based system showing three data points: Optimistic · Typical · Busy time — based on real historical data for that restaurant and current conditions. Add a small note like "Based on your past 3 orders from this restaurant: avg. 38 mins." This honesty actually increases user satisfaction even when delivery takes longer, because expectations are correctly set.

Mockup Description: On the restaurant card and checkout screen, replace "30 mins" with a small timeline bar: "25–45 mins today · Usually 32 mins · Live: slightly busy." A subtle

amber indicator appears when conditions are busier than usual, so users can make an informed choice before ordering.

Impact: Rebuilds trust in time estimates, reduces order cancellations caused by disappointment, and sets realistic expectations — all without slowing down the ordering process.

Page 5: Conclusion & Key Learnings

Summary

Zomato is a mature, feature-rich platform with several genuinely strong UX decisions — particularly its visual content strategy, live tracking, and social proof integration. However, the app suffers from complexity-driven friction: too much information on the homepage, a broken discount experience, and inconsistent delivery time communication. These are not small cosmetic issues — they occur at the most emotionally critical moments of the user journey (deciding to order, applying a discount, waiting for delivery) and therefore have outsized impact on overall user satisfaction.

Key UX Learnings from This Analysis

- 1. Clarity beats completeness.** Showing users everything at once (every promotion, every section, every feature) feels helpful from a business perspective but overwhelming from a user perspective. Good UX curates information rather than dumping it.
- 2. Never disappoint users at critical moments.** A coupon failing at checkout or a delivery arriving 20 minutes late than estimated creates a disproportionately negative emotional reaction. UX design must protect these moments above all others.
- 3. Personalization reduces friction.** The more an app remembers about its users — their preferences, past orders, favorite restaurants — the faster and more effortless the experience becomes. Zomato has the data to do this better than it currently does.
- 4. Transparency builds trust.** Users can handle bad news (longer delivery, no available offers) — what they cannot handle is being surprised by it. Honest, clear communication at every step is more valuable than optimistic estimates.

Final Note

This case study was conducted as part of a UI/UX Design Internship task at CodeAlpha. All analysis is based on direct app usage, publicly available user feedback, and established UX evaluation frameworks. Improvement mockups were created in Figma as part of this submission.

Figma Mockups Link:

https://www.figma.com/design/CCeoK3FbjLpL0HTY2BJsB8/Personal_Portfolio_Website_v1?node-id=53-2&t=RscbAVfLOyjFzZgA-1